A unified beneficiary-level dataset of subsidies in the EU

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Outline

1. Why we need this database
2. How we construct it
3. The resulting database and its completeness
4. Use cases so far
5. Future work

Why make this database?

A missing piece

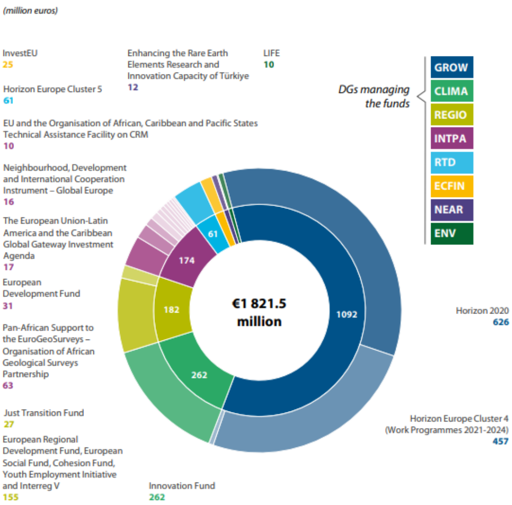
- Subsidies in the EU are given by the EU, by member states at several administrative levels, or by other institutions (e.g. EIB) to companies.
- The information is scattered: published register by register, in different places, formats, and legal reporting obligations.
- Nobody can currently answer "what did this company, sector, or supply chain receive, from whom?" without reconciling the registers first.

1. Why we need this database

A bottom-up answer

- You cannot ask the registers for "total EU subsidies to solar" or "to industrial policy". They publish award by award, with no consistent sector or policy-objective label, scattered register by register.
- Our approach: hand the database any company list (a sector's firms, a supply chain, a strategic-project roster) and it returns the subsidies they received, across all channels.
- Resolved entities carry national identifiers, so the same list joins to ORBIS, Bloomberg, or patent data.

Figure 6 | EU funding for critical raw materials and its management is fragmented (2014-2027)



2. How we construct it

1 DATA SOURCES

State aid awards (e.g. TAM)

Aid ID	Country	Amount	Instr.	Date
1001	DE	500,000	Grant	2021-01-15
1002	FR	250,000	Grant	2021-02-20
			…	…

EU funds (FTS, Cohesion, CORDIS)

Project ID	MS	Disbursed	Instr.	Year
P-2001	ES	1,250,000	Grant	2022
P-2002	PL	750,000	Guarantee	2022
…	…	…	…	…

International Financing Institutions (EIB, EIF, EBRD)

Loan ID	Country	Signed amt	Instr.	Year
L-3001	IT	10,000,000	Loan	2021
L-3002	RO	5,500,000	Loan	2021
…	…	…	…	…

State aid decision PDFs
Commission decisions, co-financing clauses, beneficiary detail, amendments

User-provided company list

Company list
Company A
Company B
Company C
…

2 MASTER DATASET

All sources concatenated into a common schema

ID	Country	Disbursement	Instrument	Year	Source
1001	DE	500,000	Grant	2021	State aid
1002	FR	250,000	Grant	2021	State aid
…	…	…	…	…	…
P-2001	ES	1,250,000	Grant	2022	EU funds
P-2002	PL	750,000	Guarantee	2022	EU funds
…	…	…	…	…	…
L-3001	IT	10,000,000	Loan	2021	IFI
L-3002	RO	5,500,000	Loan	2021	IFI
…	…	…	…	…	…

Harmonisation approach
- Map source-specific fields into a common 75-column schema
- Preserve granularity and instrument type
- Standardise dates, currencies, country codes
- Retain source provenance per row

3A ENRICHMENT

For EU funds and International Financing Institutions

Add context to structured-source rows

ID	Country	Disbursement	Instrument	Year	Source	Enriched info
1001	DE	500,000	Grant	2021	State aid	—
1002	FR	250,000	Grant	2021	State aid	—
…	…	…	…	…	…	…
P-2001	ES	1,250,000	Grant	2022	EU funds	PV installation
P-2002	PL	750,000	Guarantee	2022	EU funds	IF co-financing
…	…	…	…	…	…	…
L-3001	IT	10,000,000	Loan	2021	IFI	CRMA Scheme
L-3002	RO	5,500,000	Loan	2021	IFI	Relief loan
…	…	…	…	…	…	…

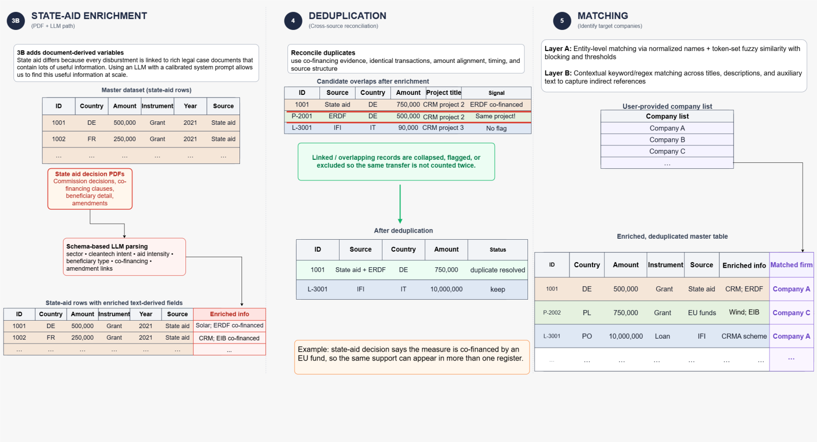
GOAL OF ENRICHMENT ?

The more text we can gather describing a subsidy, the more likely we are to accurately capture it later in the pipeline.

How enrichment works (EU funds + IFIs)
- Join supplementary registries and participant/promoter data
- Scrape project-level or borrower-level context by source IDs
- Add text metadata and linked attributes to the correct row
- New red column = enriched context

Examples of added context
programme titles • project subjects • participant/promoter names • location / sector metadata

2. How we construct it



2. How we construct it

What a row means

- **Aid element:** face value and grant equivalent[1] on every row, with a label saying how the conversion was made.
- **Scope and stage:** support vs EU share vs project cost; committed vs planned vs spent. Headlines sum committed support only.
- **Prices:** as published and deflated to 2025 euros.
- **Beneficiaries:** resolved with national identifiers first; names second.
- **Overlaps:** an award reported by both a member state and the Commission are linked to prevent double-counting.

[1] The grant equivalent restates a subsidy as the cash grant of equal benefit: for a loan, the interest saved versus market terms; for a guarantee, the risk premium avoided.

2. How we construct it

Enriching a row with its decision text

State-aid register row

Beneficiary	Olympia Odos S.A.
Country	Greece
Year	2021
Amount	€216.6m (grant)
Objective	Regional development
Sector	Roads and motorways
EU co-financing	*???*

$\Rightarrow$

Commission decision text

"...additional State support, partly financed by the European Regional Development Fund (ERDF), for the construction of the section from Korinthos to Patra..."

extracted: **EU co-financing = ERDF**

We parse the Commission's decision PDFs and link them to the award by case id; a tiered rule records co-financing as confirmed, conditional, or absent.

3. The resulting database

- Unified beneficiary-level database of EU public financial support.
- 28.5M rows across 15 sources.
- €2,711bn of budgetary support 2016–2025 (grant equivalent, real 2025 prices), plus €414bn of EIB/EBRD lending at face value.
- Coverage 1980–2027 (varies by source), densest for 2014–2025.

3. The resulting database

Sources covered

Funding type	Register	Instrument	Level
State aid (EU register)	TAM	grants, loans, guar., tax	award
State aid (national)	ES, PL, RO, SI	same, below threshold	award
Cohesion policy	Kohesio	grants	project
EU funds, direct + indirect mgmt	FTS	grants / mixed	commitment
Research	CORDIS	grants	participation
Climate and infrastructure	CINEA	grants	grant
Development banks	EIB / EBRD	loans, equity, guar.	operation

3. The resulting database

By source

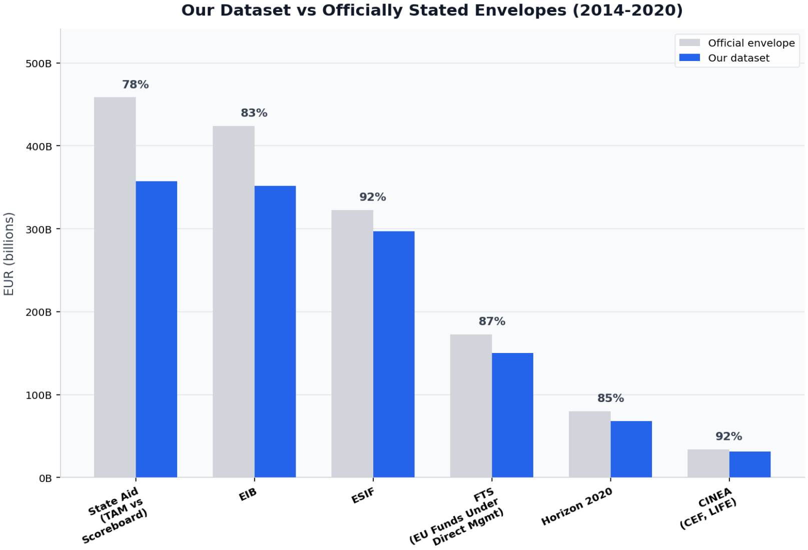
Funding type	Face €bn	GGE €bn	Years
State aid	2,243	1,833	2016–2026
EU funds	1,714	1,616	1990–2027
EIB / EBRD	1,912	287	1980–2025

3. Completeness

Captured amounts vs official envelopes

Programme	Official (€bn)	Captured (€bn)	Coverage (%)
State aid 2016–2024	1,141	849	74
EIB 2014–2024	684	587	86
ESIF 2014–2024	483	438	91
FTS direct mgmt 2014–2024	394	356	90
Horizon 2020	80	68	85
Horizon Europe	94	58	62
Innovation Fund 2021–2024	16	12	74

3. Completeness



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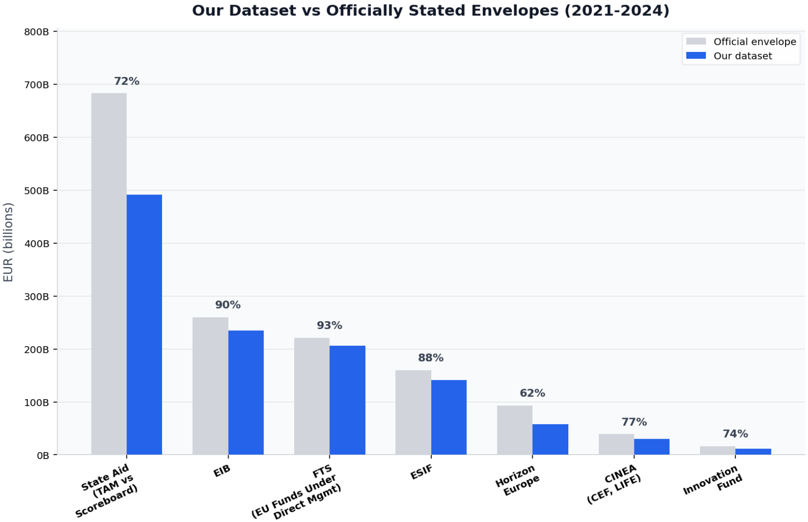

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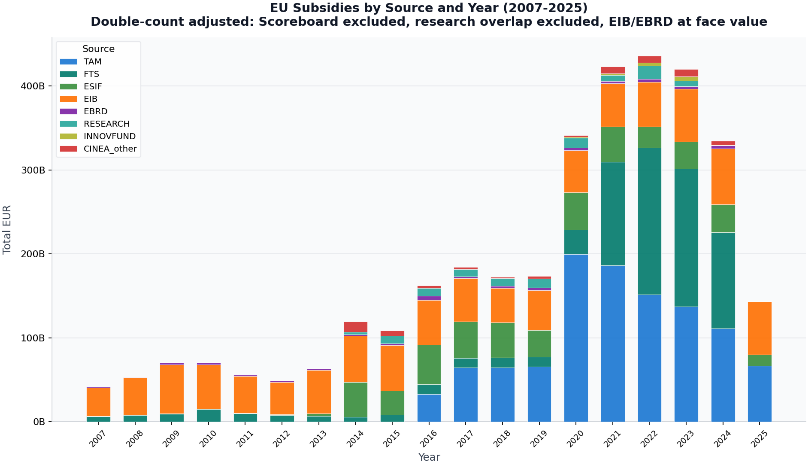


4. Use cases so far

Clean tech: subsidies next to ECCT investment figures

Technology	Investment (€bn)	Subsidies (€bn)	Ratio (%)
Battery and EVs	138.1	10.5	7.6
Solar	9.9	0.6	6.1
Wind	3.1	0.4	11.8
Green steel	37.1	6.1	16.4
Total	**188.2**	**17.6**	**9.3**

4. Use cases so far

Automotive: who subsidises whom

Headquarters	OEMs	Battery, components	Total
EU	5.7	20.9	26.6
US	0.4	0.2	0.6
Japan	0.5	0.0	0.6
Korea	0.1	0.9	1.0
China	0.9	0.8	1.7
Other	0.2	2.2	2.4
Total	**7.8**	**25.1**	**32.9**

4. Use cases so far

Critical raw materials: support for CRMA Strategic Projects

- 47 EU Strategic Projects; matched rows screened for raw-material activity with text evidence.
- **€1.25bn** of CRM-linked support, 21 projects, 2016–2025.
- Decomposable by channel: EU funds €576m, development banks €218m, state aid €461m.

5. Future work

- **Unified policy objectives:** infer a consistent two-level objective from the enriched text (level 1, e.g. industrial policy; level 2, e.g. manufacturing support for solar), giving the sector and objective slice the registers do not carry.
- **ORBIS linkage:** balance sheets, ownership trees, and group structures on top of resolved entities.
- **More data:**
  - Common Agricultural Policy (EAGF, EAFRD)
  - Modernisation Fund, STEP-labelled projects
  - RRF beneficiary data from national portals as they mature

5. Future work

Where it goes next

- **Clean Tech Tracker:** clean-tech subsidies, for manufacturing and deployment
- **The Atlas:** 4 pages of clean-tech production subsidy landscape
- **A standalone database:** the full dataset extending beyond clean-tech, as a Bruegel resource in its own right.

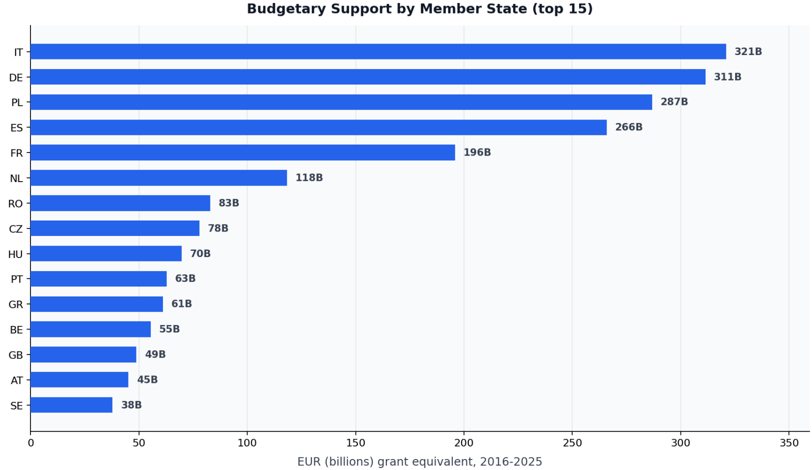
Thank you!

Comments, ideas?

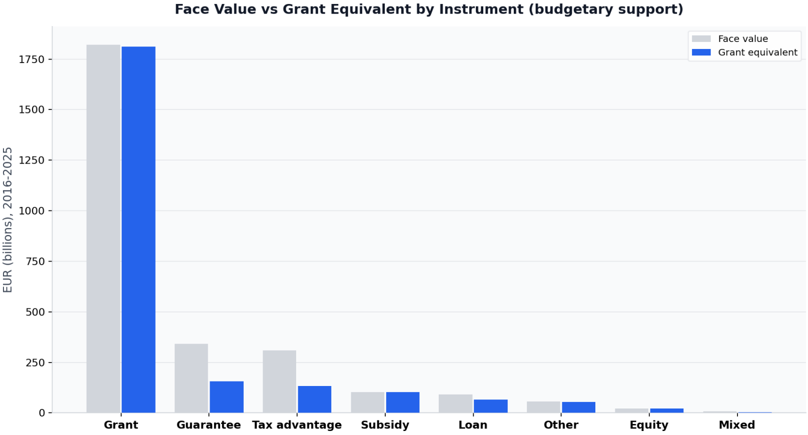
Appendix

Detail on the dataset, its measurement choices, and its checks.

A1. Support by member state



A2. Face value vs grant equivalent



A3. Where grant equivalents come from

Grant-equivalent method	Rows	€bn	Share
identity grant	4,222,088	1,973	75.8%
source provided	22,317,062	583	22.4%
calibrated ratio	233,320	42	1.6%
assumed class rate	291	6	0.2%
none	3,419	–	–

Register-provided figures dominate; estimated ratios are calibrated on 21.9M awards where both figures are observed.

A4. Calibrated aid-element ratios

Instrument	Observed pairs	Median ratio	P25	P75
other	10,153,376	0.998	0.995	1.005
grant	8,638,290	1.000	1.000	1.000
guarantee	1,440,345	0.034	0.000	0.132
tax advantage	1,033,539	0.105	0.031	1.000
loan	536,302	0.982	0.974	1.000
debt relief	93,428	0.998	0.989	1.005
subsidy	5,921	0.999	0.991	1.008
equity	1,439	1.000	0.995	1.004

Median observed aid element per euro of face value, by instrument. Guarantees carry 3.4 percent; tax-advantage reporting is bimodal across member states.

A5. External benchmarks

Benchmark	Published	Ours	Reading
EIB intra-EU signatures, 2022	$\sim$54	52.8	within 2%
EIB intra-EU signatures, 2023	$\sim$65	63.2	within 2%
COVID aid 2020–22: approved	3,050		
nominal disbursed	1,097		
aid element	472	411	at the aid-element ancho
Horizon 2020 envelope	$\sim$80	68.3	85% signed

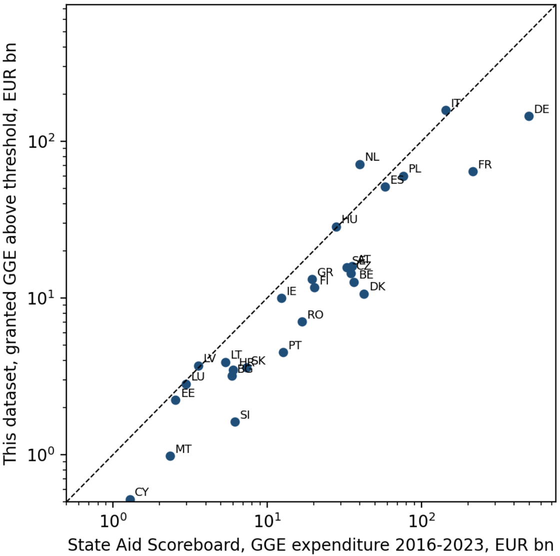
EUR billions. The COVID triptych is the sharpest test: we land at the grant-equivalent anchor, an order below ceilings and face values.

A6. The same grants through two systems

Projects	N	FTS €bn	CORDIS €bn	Log corr.	Within 10%
Signed by 2019	25,542	44.07	43.62	1.0	99%
All joint projects	41,387	80.02	79.09	1.0	99%

Horizon project totals rebuilt independently from FTS commitments and CORDIS signed contributions: 99% agree within 10%, median gap zero. Bounds pipeline processing error.

A7. Ours vs the State Aid Scoreboard, by country

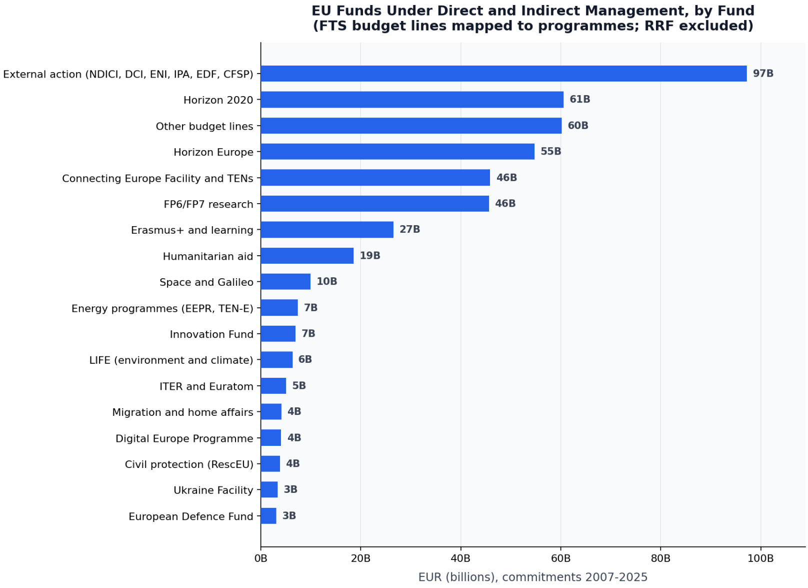


A8. Co-financing decomposition evidence

Evidence tier	Confidence	Rows
case join	high	6,936,329
rate join	high	1,691,489
explicit flag	high	225,935
pdf extracted	high	205,783
inferred match	low	69,582
none	–	44,688

An award reported by a member state and by the Commission is linked and split, not deleted; every link carries its evidence tier.

A9. EU funds under direct and indirect management



A10. Sensitivity to grant-equivalent policy

Policy	Headline (€bn)
Calibrated instrument-country ratios (default)	2,351
Flat class rates for estimated rows only	2,347
Flat class rates for all non-published rows	2,225

Budgetary support 2016–2025, nominal. The choice of estimation ratios moves the headline by 0.2 percent because most support is grants and register-published grant equivalents are always respected.